

So can you have only one niche? No, not necessary. You can host your projects on various websites and cater to two niches. Minimise the overlap and you should still be good to go..

Update regularly

Once you have built a portfolio, don't forget about it. It's like a pet- you need to look after it, nurture it and grow it. As a client, you would prefer to see latest projects, not some 3 year old long forgotten, maybe currently irrelevant piece of work. Tabulate your projects and once you complete an assignment, compare it with the other pieces in your portfolio. Is it better than what you already have? Is it more relevant to your area of expertise? Does it reflect current styles and trends better? If the answer to most of the questions is yes, replace an older project with the newer one. Ideally, don't include anything older than a year in your portfolio.

Provide a snapshot

When you post a project, don't just give a link and a description. Upload a screenshot or a snippet of the project and then the link. A potential client will appreciate being able to view a thumbnail of the project and then deciding whether to go into in detail. It also acts as a teaser and hook to draw in your clients.

Biography and Testimonials

Your portfolio talks about you, not just your work. Include a short bio of yourself along with your education, previous work experience, no. of years of experience etc. This build your credibility and makes a hiring decision easier. Also, you never know when the collegial old boy network may come into play and someone may decide to look at you closer simply because you went to the same college.

Testimonials is the second most important part of your portfolio. A testimonial gives a client's opinion about your work and is of course more trusted by potentials than your own word. It also helps create a buzz and start word of mouth advertising. If a job is well done and you maintain good relationship with the client, you can easily get a testimonial from them. Also, it increases your chances of being hired by them a second time. Psychologically speaking, when they write a testimonial for you, your good side is imprinted upon and they are also invested in you. If a similar requirement crops up in the future, 8 times out of 10, they will think of you. **d**